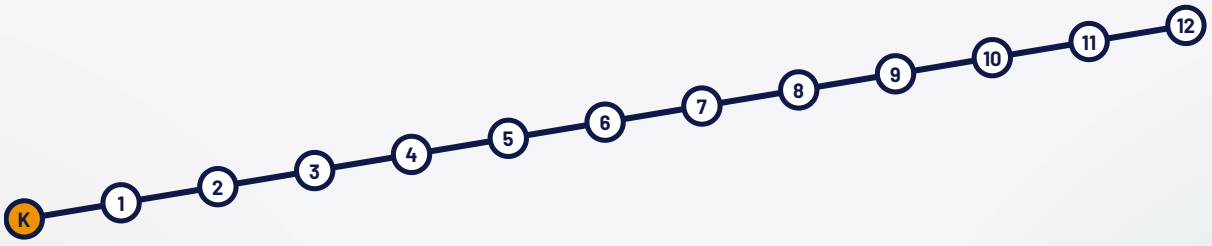
Awsaj Academy

K-12 VERTICAL ALIGNMENT · AN ANALYTICAL WALKTHROUGH

# Our Curriculum Journey: K–5

What our teachers' ratings tell us about how our standards are taught, K-12, and where we could go next.




**From the ratings you entered as teachers** (2,709 ratings, November 2026): what was reported as taught, not what students know.

# Contents


| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Elementary, K-5**<br>Kindergarten to Grade 5, all four subjects. | **3** |
| 2 | **About the data (at the back)**<br>Where the data comes from, how to read the ratings, the words we use, the limits. | **10** |


Each part: the picture (curricular capacity, grade by grade), then Facts, Patterns and Moving forward, five items each. Items link to the Vertical Alignment site. About the data is at the back. 13 pages, A4.

Taught in depth  Introduced / exposed  Not taught

ELEMENTARY, KINDERGARTEN TO GRADE 5

# Elementary, K-5

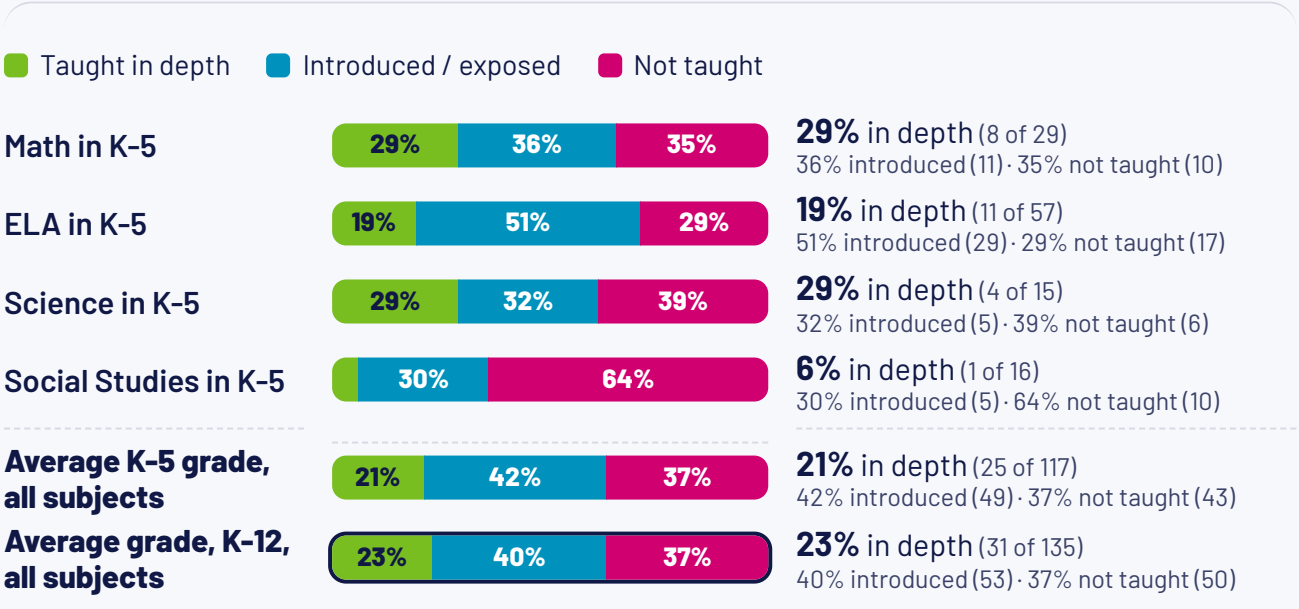
In K-5, teachers reported that 63% of the 700 grade-level ratings are at least introduced, and 21% are taught in depth. Grade 2 has the highest share in depth of any grade, and Math and Science lead the band at 29% each.

THE PICTURE

## At a glance: our curricular capacity

**What you are seeing.** An average grade in a year, by subject: green in depth, blue introduced, pink not taught, with the number of standards.

**What it adds to our story.** K-5 introduces widely. Math and Science go deepest, and Social Studies is mostly rated not taught.




Curricular capacity: what an average grade reports taking to depth, introducing or not teaching in a year. From 700 grade-level ratings, Essential Elements apart. Not a target.

Open the coverage map on the site ↗

THE PICTURE

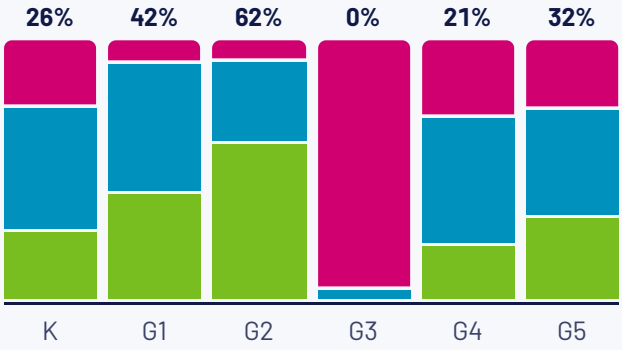
# Grade by grade

**What you are seeing.** One column per grade. The top number is the share taught in depth.

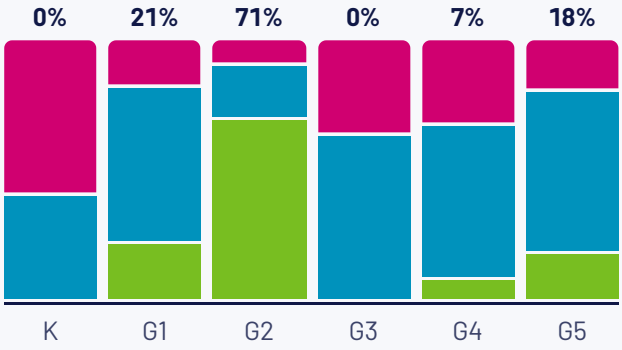
**What it adds to our story.** Grade 2 shows how deep teaching can go. The grades around it rated far fewer standards in depth, which is worth talking about together.

Taught in depth  Introduced / exposed  Not taught

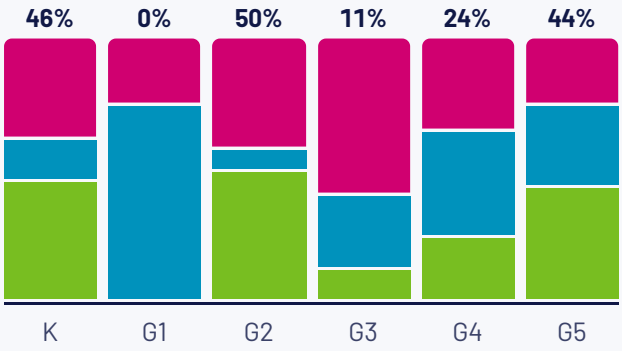
## Math



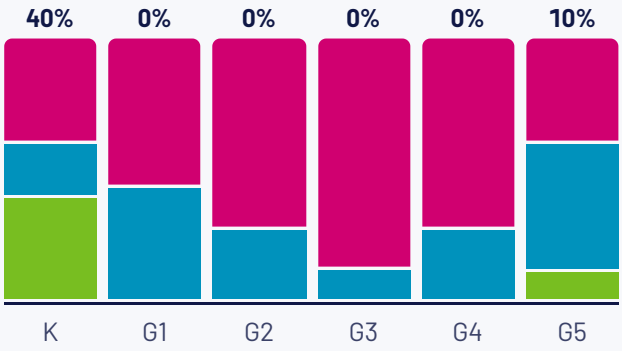

## ELA




## Science




## Social Studies



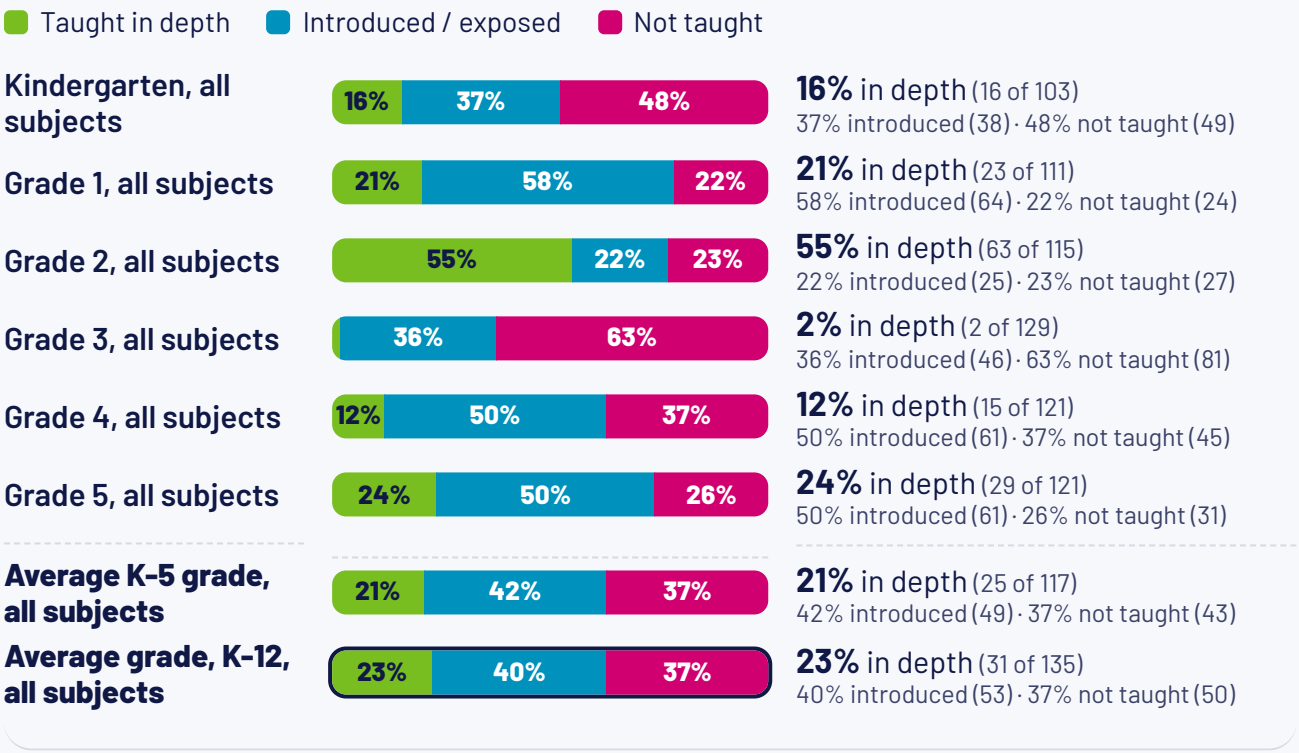

Open the grade dashboards ↗  Gaps and repetition ↗  Progressions ↗

THE PICTURE

## Our curricular capacity

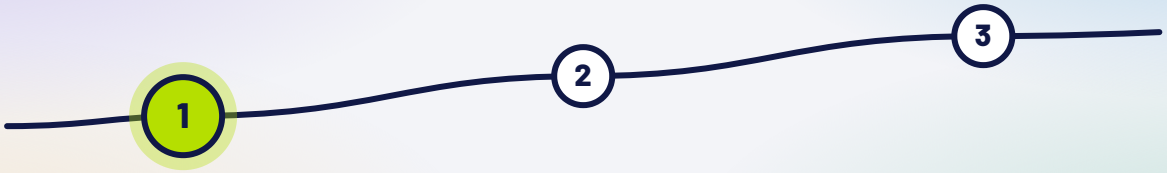
**What you are seeing.** One bar per average grade in a year, with the number of standards beside it; the school average last.

**What it adds to our story.** A K-5 grade takes 21% of its grade-level standards to depth in a year (about 25 of 117), introduces 42% (49) and does not teach 37% (43). The average grade K-12, all subjects, takes 23% to depth (about 31 of 135).



K-5 · OUR CURRICULUM JOURNEY

**Section 1: Facts**




**Facts**
YOU ARE HERE

Patterns

Moving forward

SECTION 1 OF 3

# Facts

**What you are seeing.** The five main facts. Each links to its data on the site.

**What it adds to our story.** The foundations are strongest in number (place value). Fractions, Language and Social Studies are the thinner threads.

1. BRIGHT SPOTS **Place value and Life Science are our strongest strands.** 60% of Number and Operations in Base Ten ratings are in depth, including every Grade 2 standard. In Science, Life Science is 47% in depth, Physical Science 31%, Earth and Space 25% and Engineering 11%. Grade 2 dashboard ↗

2. GAPS **Fractions are the thinnest Math strand.** None of the 30 fractions ratings in Grades 3 to 5 is in depth, and 63% are not taught. Operations and Algebraic Thinking, which also leads into middle school Math, is 23% in depth with 43% not taught. Coverage map ↗

3. GAPS **Standards not taught in their own grade.** 222 K-5 standards are rated not taught in their own grade: ELA 100, Math 60, Social Studies 38, Science 24. Gaps and repetition ↗

4. GAPS **Progressions that break down.** 39 of 109 K-5 progressions break down on an official link, and 18 are taught at every step (11 of them in Science). Six Math progressions break down, from counting and place value to area and volume. Progressions ↗

5. BREADTH WITHOUT DEPTH **Introduced, not taken to depth.** 294 standards are introduced by their grade but not taken to depth: ELA 174, Math 63, Social Studies 29, Science 28. Grade 1 at least introduces 78% of its standards, the highest of any grade K-12. Grade 1 dashboard ↗




SECTION 2 OF 3

# Patterns

**What you are seeing.** What the facts show side by side. Possibilities to discuss, not conclusions.

**What it adds to our story.** Much deep teaching in K-5 may happen at the level students are at (the Essential Elements), which the main ratings do not show.

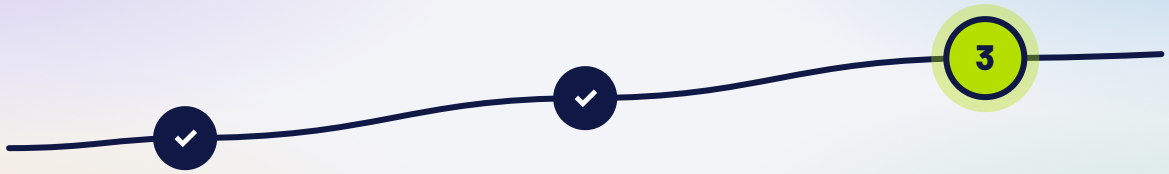
1. TRENDS ACROSS THE GRADES **Social Studies starts well and fades.** Kindergarten has 40% in depth. Grades 1 to 4 rated none of their Social Studies standards in depth, and Grades 2, 3 and 4 rate 73% to 89% not taught, perhaps because much of that time goes to literacy.
Kindergarten dashboard ↗

2. HANDOFFS **Many hand-over gaps begin in K-5.** 34 hand-over gaps begin in K-5 (Science 17, ELA 12, Social Studies 5). Nine of the Science ones, all on suggested links, start in K-5 Physical Science and feed Grade 8 and Grade 10 Physical Science. Progressions ↗

3. LANGUAGE AND LITERACY **Language is the thinnest ELA strand.** Language has 43 of the 100 ELA standards rated not taught in their own grade, and 52 of the 174 that are only introduced. Even Grade 2 Language is 31% in depth, against 78% to 100% for its other ELA strands.
Gaps and repetition ↗

4. ESSENTIAL ELEMENTS **Grade 3 may be teaching where students are.** Grade 3 rated most of its Essential Elements in depth (Math 59%, ELA 66%), while 31 of its 32 grade-level Math standards are rated not taught. One reading: teams teach in depth at the level students are at.
Coverage map ↗

5. CHOICES AND CAPACITY **Power standards are not yet our most secure.** Power standards are 20% in depth, level with all standards (21%). Kindergarten names 47 of its 57 ELA standards as power, and Grade 3 rates 17 of its 18 Math power standards not taught.
Priority and power (Audit) ↗




SECTION 3 OF 3

# Moving forward

**What you are seeing.** Five questions for teams, each with its data and a first step we could take.

**What it adds to our story.** What every child carries into Grade 6.

1

IMPROVING THE CURRICULUM **How could each grade take its own grammar, conventions and vocabulary standards to depth?**

*(Data: K-5 Language is 10% in depth; Kindergarten Language is 93% not taught)* see Grade by grade chart

**First step:** We could choose each grade's 2 thinnest strands, such as Language, and plan one unit that takes them further.

Kindergarten dashboard ↗

2

WORKING ACROSS GRADE LEVELS **What is Grade 2 doing that lets so much reach depth, and what could other grades borrow?**

*(Data: Grade 2 in depth: ELA 71%, Math 62%, Science 50%)* see Grade by grade chart

**First step:** We might ask Grade 2 to walk the K-5 team through how it plans a standard to depth.

Coverage map ↗

3

KNOWING THE BANDS ABOVE AND BELOW **Fractions begin in Grade 3 and feed ratios and algebra: what would a Grade 3 to Grade 6 plan for fractions look like?**

*(Data: 19 fractions standards not taught in their own grade; none in depth in Grades 3 to 5)* see Grade by grade chart

**First step:** We might plan one fractions sequence from Grade 3 to Grade 6, with a shared check at the end of each year.

Gaps and repetition ↗

4

IMPROVING THE CURRICULUM **How can we embed Social Studies standards in the reading and writing we already teach in Grades 1 to 4?**

*(Data: No Social Studies standard rated in depth in Grades 1 to 4; not taught 57%, 74%, 89% and 73%)* see Pattern 1

**First step:** We could teach one Social Studies standard each term through a reading or writing unit we already run.

Coverage map ↗

5

HOW WE RATE AND PLAN **If Essential Elements are where much of our in-depth teaching sits, how do we plan from them up to the grade-level standard?**

*(Data: Essential Elements in depth: Math 82% against 29% for Math standards; ELA 46% against 19%)* see At a glance chart

**First step:** We might ask Grade 3 to share what it teaches below grade level, and how it plans from there to the grade-level standard.

Coverage map ↗

WHERE THE NUMBERS COME FROM AND HOW TO READ THEM

# About the data

What our teachers reported about how our standards are taught, K-12. Eight parts: the whole school, the three grade bands and the four subjects. Each part opens with the picture (curricular capacity, grade by grade), then Facts, Patterns and Moving forward, five items each.

ABOUT THE DATA

## How to read this paper

> **What you are seeing.** How the ratings were made, what the three ratings mean, and the words we use.
>
> **What it adds to our story.** It helps us read every number fairly: these are teachers' reports of teaching, not measures of what students know.

What our teachers reported about how our standards are taught, K-12. Eight parts: the whole school, the three grade bands and the four subjects. Each part opens with the picture (curricular capacity, grade by grade), then Facts, Patterns and Moving forward, five items each.

**Where the numbers come from.** The ratings sheet of 9 November 2026 (2,166 standards, 2,709 ratings), checked against the Vertical Alignment reports.

**The three ratings.**

| Rating | What it means |
|---|---|
| Taught in depth | ALL classes in the grade consistently teach, reteach, review and assess the standard |
| Introduced / exposed | Anything in between (for example, 3 of 5 classes) |
| Not taught | No class in the grade teaches it |

**Keep in mind.**

- The ratings report teaching across a whole grade, not what students know, and they judge no one.
- "In depth" is all or nothing. Teams may have read it more or less strictly.
- Much literacy is also taught in Science and Social Studies, and may not show in the ELA ratings.
- Shares are of grade-level ratings. Essential Elements are counted apart.

**Curricular capacity.** What an average grade reports taking to depth, introducing or not teaching in a year. Not a target: we cannot teach everything equally, so we choose the mix on purpose.

**Categories.** Each item carries a small label (for example Bright spots, Gaps, Handoffs), the same set in every part, so a team can follow one kind of observation across parts.

ABOUT THE DATA

## Method, sources and limits

> **What you are seeing.** How the ratings were made, what the three ratings mean, and the words we use.
>
> **What it adds to our story.** It helps us read every number fairly: these are teachers' reports of teaching, not measures of what students know.

Every figure in this paper was computed from the ratings sheet and cross-checked against the site. Where the site's band and K-12 views differ (progressions), the paper says which it uses. Percentages are rounded half up, as on the site.

### What was read

| Source | How it was used | How fully it was read |
|---|---|---|
| Ratings sheet, "All Standards and Ratings K-12" (9 Nov 2026) | Every figure | All 2,166 rows |
| Organized ratings workbook | Cross-check of totals | All tabs |
| 20 Findings decks (band and subject) | Cross-check, questions and next-step themes | All slides and speaker notes |
| K-12 Reports PDF (118 pages) | Cross-check | First 80 pages scanned by search; a few read directly |
| 7 other Reports PDFs | Cross-check of headline figures | Scanned by search, not read page by page |

### How terms are used

- **Rated standards.** One rating is one standard in one grade. A standard shared by several grades is counted once for each grade that rated it.
- **At least introduced.** Rated in depth or introduced.
- **Not taught where it belongs (confirmed).** The grade the standard belongs to rated it not taught (for a standard shared across grades, every grade that shares it did). In Math and ELA each standard belongs to one grade, so this means that grade's team rated it not taught; it does not mean other grades should have taught it.

- **Not taught where it fits.** Each standard was placed in the grade or course where it fits best, and that grade or course rated it not taught. Other grades were not asked to rate it.
- **Introduced, not taken to depth.** Rated introduced by the grade (or grades) that rate it, and in depth by none. Most standards belong to one grade, so this counts what each grade introduces without taking to depth; it does not mean another grade should teach it again.
- **Progression finding.** An automatic check on a chain of linked standards: a step not taught, or a standard in depth while the one it builds on is not taught.
- **Taught at every step.** Every standard in the chain, across two or more grades, is at least introduced.
- **Progression.** A chain of linked standards across grades. Official links are the Coherence Map (Math), anchor standards (ELA) and the standards' own structure (Science, Social Studies). Other links are suggestions.
- **Curricular capacity.** The average number of standards one grade rated in depth, introduced and not taught in a year (all ratings divided by the number of grades), rounded.
- **Hand-over gap.** A standard taught in depth while a standard it builds on, placed in an earlier school, is rated not taught.
- **Priority and power standards.** Standards the school's own documents name: power standards in K-5, priority standards in 6-12.

**Limits to keep in view**

- Ratings are teachers' judgements of teaching across a grade. They are not observations and not student results.
- Grades may have read "in depth" differently. Uniform ratings across a whole grade are a reason to check how the scale was read; the paper points these out so teams can discuss them.
- Each team rated its own subject. Literacy taught in Science and Social Studies, and Math taught in Science, may not show in the ELA and Math ratings.
- Middle school Science and high school Math, Science and Social Studies standards were placed in the grade or course where each fits best. 24 K-5 Social Studies standards are also rated not taught in the grade where they fit.
- Band counts of progressions look only at steps inside the band, so they do not add up to the K-12 figure.

- Literacy audit figures come from the 2026 PK-5 literacy audit of weekly plans.
- Some strands have few standards in a grade, so a single rating can move a percentage a long way. Counts are given where this matters.
- Suggested links between standards (most ELA, Science and Social Studies hand-overs) have not been checked by teachers.

**Status.** This is a draft for the Vertical Alignment Committee. Each finding should be checked with the teams concerned before it is treated as settled. The planned review of weekly and unit plans (Part 2) will test many of these patterns against what is actually planned.